Radiography safety

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1 Before taking X-rays

Ask every patient who could be pregnant whether she is or may be pregnant. If the answer is yes or unsure, postpone any X-ray that is not urgent. For an urgent X-ray, the dentist decides, and the patient wears a lead apron.

2 Protection

Use a thyroid collar for every intra-oral X-ray. Staff stand behind the protective screen, or at least 2 metres away and out of the main beam, during every exposure. Never hold the film for a patient.

3 Dosimeter badges

Staff who take X-rays wear a dosimeter badge at work. The badges are sent away for reading every quarter.

4 How often to take X-rays

Adults at low risk of decay get bitewing X-rays every 2 years at their check-up. Patients at high risk of decay get them every year.

5 Equipment

Every X-ray unit is licensed and gets a quality control test once a year.